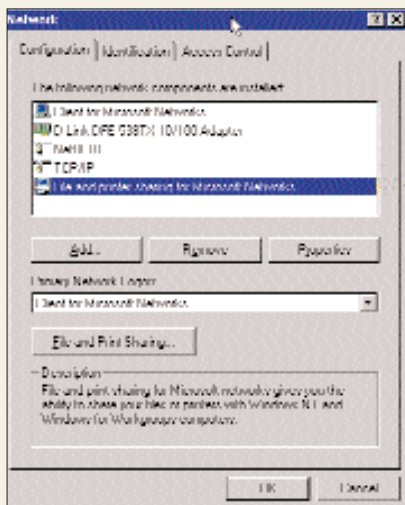




Disable file sharing

why file and print sharing feature should be enabled. To disable it, open Control Panel and double-click on the Network icon. You will see a list of installed protocols, including 'File and Print Sharing for Microsoft Networks'. Click on File and Print Sharing, then click Remove, and finally click OK. Reboot your PC to save the changes.

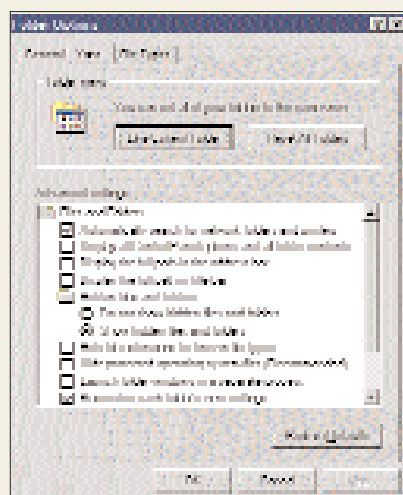
Unbinding NetBIOS to TCP/IP

By default, NetBIOS is bound to TCP/IP protocol, and therefore it is possible for outside intruders to access your file shares. You can prevent this by unbinding NetBIOS to TCP/IP. Firstly, you need to have NetBEUI installed along with TCP/IP. (Install NetBEUI from the Protocols options in the Network Configuration menu). Now, select the Dial-up Adapter that you use to connect to the Internet, and click on Properties. Go to the Bindings tab, and uncheck all the boxes except for the TCP/IP Dial-up Adapter. Click OK. Now, select TCP/IP > Dial-up Adapter, and click on Properties. Ignore any warning messages, and click the Bindings tab. Uncheck all the boxes present here, and click OK. You will get another warning message, but click No at this juncture. Close the Network properties menu and restart the machine. This will result in NetBIOS being

unbound to TCP/IP and you no longer have to worry about your file shares being accessed over the Net.

Enabling file extensions

By default Windows Explorer hides file extensions for known file types, and this includes the .vbs extension which is also used to create many of the malicious scripts. Therefore, it's quite possible that you might receive an attachment in your e-mail with the actual file name as good-image.jpg.vbs, but since the .vbs is a known file extension, it gets hidden and you perceive the file name as goodimage.jpg and since .jpg files are non-executable you open it. This could cause the Visual Basic Script to execute whatever code is written in it (provided you have Active Scripting enabled). To



Uncheck the option to hide known file extensions

prevent this from happening, go to the Explorer Window, select Tools > Folder Options, click on the View Tab and uncheck the 'Hide file extensions for known file types' option.

Scraping past security

What happens when you try to paste, say, the contents of your Word document into the Explorer folder? You get what is known as a scrap document or scrap

object, which is basically a wrapper for OLE data. Double-clicking on the scrap file launches any program that may have been defined in the properties of the scrap object. The scrap object icon is quite similar to the icon for a text document, and even if Windows Explorer is configured to show all extensions, it hides the .shs extension that is associated with a scrap document. So, you can easily end up opening an e-mail attachment, say, goodstuff.txt.shs (which only gets displayed as goodstuff.txt), and invoke a malicious command (such as opening some file or running the format command) associated with that scrap object.

To prevent this, you have to modify some settings in the registry. Back up your registry before you proceed. Type regedit in the Run menu, and go to HKEY_CLASSES_ROOT\ShellScrap. Locate the NeverShowExt value in the right-hand pane and then delete this value. Adopt a similar procedure for the value under HKEY_CLASSES_ROOT\DocShortcut. Now, all that's left to do is change the icons for the scrap object so that they don't resemble the text icon. Go to Windows Explorer > Tools, click on the File Types tab and select the .shs extension. Click on Advanced, and then on Change Icon. Browse to the pifmgr.dll file, and select one which presents the warning signals or the dynamite or shield, so that you know there's danger associated with such file extensions.

Changing default locations

Many intrusion attempts and malicious Web sites look at specific directories for certain files. This is done on the assumption that the software will usually be installed in the default locations. For example, Windows will most probably be in C:\Windows and other applications will be within the C:\Program Files folder.

Wherever possible, don't use the default folder and change it to some other name. This will make the task of whoever is trying to pry into your system all the more difficult.

Ad will come